CV Module/Pharmacology Drugs to Know List

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This is a comprehensive list of all CV drug classes and specific drugs you need to know for the CV exams. Since many CV drugs are used for multiple indications, we have marked the major indications for each drug class.

Note the following:

- If a drug class appears under multiple indications, it does not mean that *all* drugs in that class are necessarily used for a particular indication.
- A specific drug or drug class may not be appropriate for a particular indication in *every* patient.
- The fact that a drug is indicated for a specific CV disorder does not mean the drug is a first-line choice for that condition.

Antiplatelets/Anticoagulants/Fibrinolytics Drugs to Know:

Venous Thrombosis • DVT • PE • Afib (ppx)*		Heparin-Induced Thrombocy-topenia	Mechanical Heart Valves (ppx)*	Acute coronary syndrome	Acute ischemic stroke
Stable patients – choose 1 of the following:		Direct thrombin inhibitors: • Argatroban *or* • Bivalirudin	Warfarin	Aspirin *and* P2Y12 inhibitor • Clopidogrel *or* • Ticagrelor *and* IV or SQ Anticoagulant	Aspirin *and* Fibrinolytic *(tPA)*
IV or SQ: Heparin LMWH *(Enoxaparin)*	**PO:** Warfarin Dabigatran Apixaban Rivaroxaban Edoxaban				
For life-threatening PE: Heparin + tPA					

*PPx = prophylaxis, meaning for prevention of clot rather than treatment of known clot

Lipid Lowering Drugs to Know:

STATINS: HMG-CoA (3-hydroxy-3-methyl-glutaryl co-enzyme A) reductase inhibitors: low/medium/**high intensity (in boldface)** (Trade names in parentheses FYI only)
- **Atorvastatin** (Lipitor)
- Pravastatin (Pravachol)
- **Rosuvastatin** (Crestor)
- Simvastatin (Zocor)

BILE ACID SEQUESTRANTS: "Anion exchange resins"
- Cholestyramine (Questran)
- Colesevelam (WelChol)

FIBRATES: "Fibric acids"
- Fenofibrate (Tricor)
- Gemfibrozil (Lopid)

OTHERS:
- Ezetimibe (Zetia)
- "fish oils" (ω-3 fatty acids)
- Alirocumab (Praluent)

NOTE: An 'X' under a clinical indication does not mean that all drugs in a class are used for that indication.

Subclass/ Drug	Clinical Indication					Notes
	Angina	Hypertension	Heart Failure	Arrhythmias	Non-CV Conditions (Selected)	
DIURETICS and Other Drugs That Act on the Kidney						
Thiazides: Hydrochlorothiazide Chlorthalidone Metolazone		X	X		Calcium kidney stones	
Loop diuretics: Furosemide Torsemide		X – if more severe	X			
Aldosterone antagonists: Spironolactone Eplerenone		X	X		Hyperaldosteronism	
Na^+ channel inhibitors: Triamterene		X				
Other diuretics: Acetazolamide Mannitol					Glaucoma (Acetazolamide) Cerebral edema (Mannitol)	
SGLT2 Inhibitors: Empagliflozin Dapagliflozin			X		DM Type 2	
SYMPATHOPLEGICS, CENTRALLY ACTING						
Clonidine Methyldopa		X			Withdrawal from drugs of abuse (Clonidine)	
α BLOCKERS						
α-1 Blockers: Prazosin Doxazosin		X			BPH	

α-1A-Selective Blockers: Tamsulosin					BPH	
	Angina	**Hypertension**	**Heart Failure**	**Arrhythmias**	**Non-CV Conditions**	**Notes**
β BLOCKERS						
Non-selective Propranolol β_1-selective Metoprolol Atenolol β_1-selective & NO release Nebivolol β and α blocking Carvedilol Labetalol	X	X	X Metoprolol succinate, Carvedilol & Bisoprolol only	X	Selected BB are used for: - Migraine prophylaxis - Glaucoma – eye drops	Use for MI Not all BB listed are used for all conditions marked; depending on the condition, some are preferred over others
Ultra-short acting β_1-selective blocker for IV use only: Esmolol				X		
VASODILATORS						
Non-dihydropyridine CCBs: Verapamil Diltiazem	X	X		X		
Dihydropyridine CCBs: Nifedipine Amlodipine	X	X			Prevention of pre-term labor (Nifedipine)	
Hydralazine Minoxidil		X	X – Hydralazine/ Isosorbide dinitrate only		Hair loss – topical (Minoxidil)	
ANGIOTENSIN-CONVERTING ENZYME (ACE) INHIBITORS						
Captopril Lisinopril Enalapril		X	X		Diabetic nephropathy	Use for MI

ANGIOTENSIN RECEPTOR BLOCKERS (ARBs)						
Losartan Valsartan Candesartan		X	X		Diabetic nephropathy	Use for MI
	Angina	**Hypertension**	**Heart Failure**	**Arrhythmias**	**Non-CV Conditions**	**Notes**
ARB/NEPRILYSIN INHIBITOR						
Valsartan/Sacubitril (ARNI)			X			
NITRATES						
Nitroglycerin (sublingual; ointment; slow release/transdermal) Isosorbide dinitrate Isosorbide mononitrate	X		X –Hydralazine /Isosorbide dinitrate only			
Nitroprusside		X - HTN emergencies				
PHOSPHOPDIESTERASE-5 INHIBITORS						
Sildenafil Tadalafil					Erectile dysfunction Pulmonary Hypertension	
NA^+ CHANNEL BLOCKERS						
I_A Drugs: Procainamide Disopyramide **I_B Drugs:** Lidocaine Mexiletine **I_C Drugs:** Propafenone Flecainide				X	Local anesthesia (Lidocaine)	
Ranolazine	X			X[1]		[1] Small clinical trials – used as adjunct for AFib
K^+ CHANNEL BLOCKERS (multiple mechanisms)						

Amiodarone Dronedarone Ibutilide Dofetilide				X		
	Angina	**Hypertension**	**Heart Failure**	**Arrhythmias**	**Non-CV Conditions**	**Notes**
OTHER DRUGS FOR CARDIOVASCULAR DISORDERS						
Digoxin			X	X		
Ivabradine	X[2]		X			[2] Emerging therapy, not yet approved for angina in US
Adenosine				X		
Atropine				X		
Magnesium sulfate				X	Prevention of pre-term labor Seizure prevention in preclampsia Seizure management in eclampsia	